

embedded into Windows thus making sure that a vulnerability doesn't go too deep. Remember one fact: monitoring viral activities manually is always a lot tougher than updating your anti-virus regularly. One should always be ready to counter an infection manually but having an anti-virus protects you most of the time.

Denial of Service attacks

Denial of Service (or DoS) attacks happen via the internet. They're carried out by opening many connections to your computer and leaving them open; this consumes plenty of resources on your computer and can crash it. Though your internet connection will go bonkers before a crash, it's difficult to detect DoS because its strength lies in bombarding the computer with connection requests at a very high speed. So before you can discover what went wrong, the system would have already gotten too slow to start monitoring it.

Knowing when you've been, well, denied service

You can either get yourself a firewall package or use Windows Firewall which can normally prevent such scenarios.

We won't explain how to use them in detail since they're beyond the scope of this book and require a sound explanation of how the TCP protocol works. No need to sweat though; not only will Windows Firewall be able to defend you well, chances are high that you'll never face a DoS attack in the first place for two reasons: most ISPs use dynamic IP addresses (every time you connect, your public IP address changes) and most ISPs put you behind a NAT (Network Address Translation). Though they do it to save IP address consumption, it ends up protecting you as your public IP address maps to many people at the same time. If you're still afraid, get yourself a firewall package and relax.

Hacking

Just as in case of DoS, it's very difficult to discover signs of hacking once it's done since a

NOTE

In Windows Firewall with Advanced Security, you can create a rule which blocks all incoming connections on all TCP ports and keep the rule deactivated. If you detect a DoS, activate the rule to enable protection. Remember that enabling such a rule can disturb operations of a lot of software as well as web pages though it should not completely make your net connection useless.